

Giant millipede

Millipedes were among the first animals to walk on Earth. They took their first steps at least 428 million years ago, venturing onto land to eat the few simple, mosslike land plants that existed back then. By 350 million years ago, the plants had evolved into trees and the millipedes had become giants, too. Biggest of all was *Arthropleura*. As big as a crocodile, it was the largest invertebrate ever to live on land.

INVERTEBRATES



▲ THIS FOSSIL, measuring 3 in (7.1 cm) long, shows just a part of one of *Arthropleura*'s legs.

